



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Human Resource Division Communication Policy

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JCF- HRMD Communi- cation Policy

It is mandatory that each employee in this Division show maximum respect to every other person in the division and other contacts in a business context. The purpose of communication should be to help others and to make our service run as effectively as possible, thereby gaining the respect



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1.0 POLICY STATEMENT

JCF-HRMD seeks to communicate openly, honestly, respectfully, professionally and transparently with staff, partners, stakeholders and the public in an accurate and timely manner.

The purpose of this policy is to facilitate better communication, paving the way for better business.

1.2 OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this policy are to:

- 1.2.1 Implement a range of communication channels and procedures to facilitate regular and meaningful communication.
- 1.2.2 Increase staff morale and the quality of customer service within an environment where employees are free to express their ideas, suggestions and opinions constructively, and without prejudice.
- 1.2.3 Increase productivity and goal achievement through the communication of strategic direction of the HRMD.
- 1.2.4 Reinforce communication as a daily management activity to maintain harmonious relations with staff.
- 1.2.5 Allow for mentoring and continuous communication to facilitate a sense of camaraderie, relationship building and continuous feedback.
- 1.2.6 Emphasise the responsibility of all managers and staff to engage in regular meaningful communication on a day-to-day basis to discuss suggestions, issues and problems of common interest for the purpose of developing, maintaining and improving the overall performance of the HRMD.
- 1.2.7 Encourage supervisors to adopt an open communication style to allow/encourage staff to feel free to express their ideas, suggestions and opinions constructively, without prejudice.

2.1 SCOPE

This policy is intended for all stakeholders and members of the JCF-HR community who represent the HRMD through any mode of communication.

3.1 FORMS OF COMMUNICATION

- 3.1.1 The HRMD communicates with its customers both internally and externally via formal and informal media. The formal channels include, but are not limited to:
- 3.1.2 Internally: Memoranda, Emails, Notices/Circulars, **Public Employees' Pension Administration System (PEPAS)**,
Externally: Letters, Emails, Press Releases, HR What's App Group.

INTERNAL COMMUNICATION

- 3.1.3 SDHRMD/DHRM/DHRD/ of Units are expected to establish procedures and provide the tools to encourage and facilitate open communications across the HRMD.
- 3.1.4 Every opportunity should be taken to use 'modern Information Technology' for communication purposes.

3.1.5 STAFF MEETINGS

- 3.1.5.1 The HRMD commits to having regular meetings to communicate developments in the organisation and to address matters affecting general staff.

3.1.6 UNIT MEETINGS

- 3.1.6.1 Managers are expected to organize and execute meetings on a regular basis with staff in their respective areas of responsibility so as to troubleshoot issues affecting the Division/Department, review performance against the established goals and objectives, and to provide a forum for discussion and feedback.

3.1.7 MEMORANDA

- 3.1.7.1 Memoranda should only be circulated within the organisation where it is expected to conform to standard and not be led outside of the chain of command.
- 3.1.7.2 The standard memo should be sent from SDHRMD and not from an individual's desk.

3.1.8 LETTERS AND EMAILS

- 3.1.8.1.1 Letters are generated for external purposes, except in the case of issues being addressed by the Office of HRMD and other administrative matters.
- 3.1.8.1.2 Authorised letters should be prepared using the JCF's letterhead and should be duly signed by a Unit head or designate.
- 3.1.8.1.3 It is the responsibility of all Unit heads to ensure that letterheads are not used outside of the ambit of official HRMD business.
- 3.1.8.1.4 Emails are accepted forms of communication both internally and externally.
- 3.1.8.1.5 All emails generated from the HRMD which are sent to an external party shall be standard, in that, it should bear the name of the individual, title, company information, and individual's email address.
- 3.1.8.1.6 Emails sent internally should also conform to the same standard template.

3.1.9 CIRCULARS & NOTICES

- 3.1.9.1.1 All circulars and notices for official communication throughout the organisation must be vetted and approved by the SDHRMD or a designate. Such notices should also be posted prominently throughout the organisation.
- 3.1.9.1.2 The SDHRMD or designate should be responsible for approving and placing pieces of communication on notice boards. These notices should be clearly dated with a clear indication of the expiry date for notices to be removed.
- 3.1.9.1.3 Notices with specific time limits must be posted and circulated to ensure timely awareness and action, where necessary, by relevant members of staff.
- 3.1.9.1.4 Internal notices should be copied to all members of the relevant sections.

3.1.10 STAFF SUGGESTION INSTRUMENT

- 3.1.10.1.1 The Director of HRD should implement and oversee a staff suggestion scheme to generate and encourage new ideas and action in order to encourage and foster the voice of the internal customer.
- 3.1.10.1.2 The Director of HRD should review submitted suggestions and relay them to the relevant manager(s) for discussion and enactment where feasible.

- 3.1.10.1.3 Every effort should be made to honour commitments for action and/or feedback in the shortest possible time.
- 3.1.10.1.4 Staff shall not be compelled to indicate their names on suggestions, which are submitted. However, where identification is possible, staff involvement and initiative in this exercise should be acknowledged.
- 3.1.10.1.5 Employee surveys among all levels of staff to monitor perception and expectations of the organisation should be conducted. SDHRMD/DHRM/DHRD/ of Units shall determine the frequency of this exercise in consultation with managers and general staff.

3.1.11 CORPORATE TELEPHONE

- 3.1.11.1.1 Employees who hold positions deemed critical by the SDHRMD shall be provided with a corporate phone.
- 3.1.11.1.2 Use of the phone is guided by the Ministry of Finance, Closed User Group (CUG) Contract and appropriate MOF policies governing the use of such devices.

3.1.11.2 STAFF NOTICE BOARDS

- 3.1.11.2.1 A Staff Notice Board shall be provided by the HRMD to communicate to staff general issues and notices. The notice boards are not intended for messages of a personal nature.
- 3.1.11.2.2 Examples of such notices may include announcement of, job vacancies, staff sport and recreational programmes, information on safety, union matters and policy/organisational changes.
- 3.1.11.2.3 The HRMD will seek to use the intranet as much as possible as to so reduce paper consumption,
- 3.1.11.2.4 Employees shall not alter or deface notices placed on the board. Such acts may result in disciplinary action.

3.2 EXTERNAL COMMUNICATION

- 3.2.1 All communication with external bodies relating to/emanating from the HRMD, bearing the logo or any other official communication must be approved by the SDHRMD/DHRM/DHRD prior to such release.
- 3.2.2 Subject to the provision of the Access to Information Act, employees must obtain written approval and clearance from the appropriate authority (Permanent Secretary/

Commissioner of Police) to make public or communicate with the media or to any private individual, organisation or entity any documents, papers or information, not in the public domain which may come into the employee's possession in an official or unofficial capacity.

- 3.2.3 All oral or written communication (inclusive of emails) with external bodies on matters relating to the HRMD must be done with the full knowledge and approval/authorisation of the SDHRMD or her designated representative.
- 3.2.4 Any material, statement, documentation or other forms of communication for publication in any media must be approved by the SDHRMD or her designate prior to release.
- 3.2.5 Where the HRMD may wish to communicate using the media, the services of external expertise may be utilised. Where an employee is called upon to respond to the media or participate in interviews on public policy, approval must be sought from the (Permanent Secretary/ Commissioner of Police) care must be exercised to provide only facts for explanation and clarification.
- 3.2.6 Staff may not participate in any broadcast activity, including radio talk shows during office hours; or if the broadcast in anyway relates to the work of the HRMD, at any time without the prior permission of the Permanent Secretary/ Commissioner of Police. A breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action (See Code of Conduct).
- 3.2.7 SDHRMD/DHRM/DHRD are encouraged to adopt an attitude of transparency and inclusiveness in relating to clients and stakeholders.
- 3.2.8 The assistance and guidance of the Ministry or Agency responsible for government communication may be sought, as necessary.

3.3 SPECIAL COMMUNICATION

- 3.3.1 Special communication exercises shall include those exercises, either internal or external that are one-off, irregular and/or sensitive. For such exercises, external expertise may be engaged.
- 3.3.2 Approval to use external assistance shall be received from the **Permanent Secretary/ Commissioner of Police**. **Request for approval** from the **Permanent Secretary/ Commissioner of Police** shall be supported by a written cost benefit analysis/justification for employment of an expert.

3.4 ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Position(s)	Responsibility/Authority
Permanent Secretary/ Commissioner of Police	▪ Gives approval for the dissemination of information to the general public.
Human Resource Information System Officer	▪ Coordination of all communication activities.
Human Resource Information System Officer	▪ Maintenance of the HRMD's notice board(s) and managing the suggestion scheme.
SDHRMD/DHRM/DHRD Managers/Supervisors	▪ Engaging in regular, open and meaningful communication with their staff ▪ Disseminate relevant and correct information
Employees	▪ Give feedback via the various schemes and ensuring that the correct channels are observed in the communication process.